

UNITED KINGDOM

United Kingdom – Key Country Details

Detail	Information
Full Name	United Kingdom of Great Britain and Northern Ireland
Short Form	United Kingdom (UK)
Capital	London
Region (UN)	Western Europe
Government Type	Unitary parliamentary constitutional monarchy
Head of State	King Charles III
Head of Government	Prime Minister Keir Starmer (since 5 July 2024)
Currency	Pound Sterling (GBP)
UN Member Since	24 October 1945 (Founding Member)
MUN Standing	Permanent member of the UN Security Council (P5); influential in global diplomacy, peacekeeping, and international development.

Recommended Books on UK Foreign Policy and UN Engagement

Title	Author(s)	Relevance
<i>Britain and the United Nations</i>	Stephen Ryan	Explores the UK's historical and contemporary role within the UN framework.
<i>The Foreign Policy of the United Kingdom</i>	Jamie Gaskarth	Analyzes the UK's foreign policy decisions and their global implications.
<i>Global Britain in a Competitive Age: The Integrated Review of Security, Defence, Development and Foreign Policy</i>	UK Government	Official document outlining the UK's strategic vision post-Brexit.
<i>The United Kingdom and the United Nations: A Policy Paper</i>	Chatham House	Provides insights into the UK's priorities and challenges within the UN.
<i>The United Nations Security Council and the Politics of International Authority</i>	Bruce Cronin & Ian Hurd	Discusses the dynamics of authority within the UNSC, with references to the UK.

United Kingdom & UNCSW: Verified Research Links

 Source	Link	 Why It's Useful
UK Beijing+30 National Review (2024)	Download PDF (unwomen.org)	Comprehensive official assessment of the UK's progress in implementing the Beijing Platform—

	unwomen.org)	covers legal reforms, economic equality, care, and violence prevention.
CEDAW Concluding Observations on the UK (2024)	UN Digital Library	Offers detailed observations from the UN Committee on discrimination against women, highlighting gaps in policy and legal response.
Summary: International Human Rights Observations on Northern Ireland (2024)	Download PDF	Highlights UN treaty-body findings on gender equality issues specific to Northern Ireland—important for regional nuance.
Women's Rights in Review — 30 Years After Beijing (2025)	Download PDF	Global report with UK-specific highlights—helpful for comparing national progress with global trends.
CSW69 Beijing+30 Preparations (UN Women)	CSW69 Prep Page	Provides context for the UK's participation, thematic focus (e.g., care economy, VAW), and preparatory documents.
CSW69 Official Documents (UN Women)	CSW69 Docs	Contains agenda, themes, and decisions where UK is an active contributor—essential for referencing UK commitments.
CEDAW Inquiry Report – UK & Northern Ireland (2024)	Safe Abortion Women's Rights	Explores access to abortion in Northern Ireland—critical for sections on SRHR and legal equality.
World Conferences on Women – UN Women (Policy Context)	UN Women Archives	Archives including UK participation in Beijing conferences, offering rich policy background and evolution.
Gender Equality Laws – Comparative Note (OSCE region)	Download PDF	UK-specific legal provisions compared across OSCE countries—useful for legislative benchmarking.
UN Women Annual Highlights Report	Annual Report	Global but includes UK programmatic highlights—useful for summarizing UN-supported gender initiatives in the UK.

Source Name	Link	Why It's Useful
UN Women UK Country Page	https://uk.unwomen.org/en	Official UN Women activities and programs in the UK.
<u>UK Government Gender Equality Strategy 2022</u>	https://www.gov.uk/government/publications/uk-gender-equality-strategy	UK's comprehensive national strategy on gender equality aligned with UN goals.
<u>UK Statement at CSW66 (2022)</u>	https://www.un.org/womenwatch/daw/csw/csw66/statements/uk.pdf	Official speech outlining UK's priorities and progress at the

		66th CSW session.
<u>CEDAW UK Reports</u>	https://tbinternet.ohchr.org/_layouts/15/treatybodyexternal/Treaty.aspx?CountryID=81&Lang=EN	UK's reports submitted to the UN Committee on the Elimination of Discrimination Against Women.
<u>UK Women & Girls' Education – UNICEF UK</u>	https://www.unicef.org/ukraine/education	UNICEF UK initiatives focusing on education and gender parity.
<u>Women in Peacebuilding – UK</u>	https://peacewomen.org/member-states/united-kingdom	UK's implementation of UN Security Council Resolution 1325 on women, peace, and security.
<u>UK Gender Equality Statistics – ONS</u>	https://www.ons.gov.uk/peoplepopulationandcommunity/women	Official gender statistics covering employment, education, pay gap, etc.
<u>UK Ministry of Women and Equalities</u>	https://www.gov.uk/government/organisations/women-and-equalities-commission	Government body driving gender equality policies.
<u>UK Gender Pay Gap Reporting</u>	https://gender-pay-gap.service.gov.uk/	Official government portal for companies' gender pay gap disclosures.
<u>Equality and Human Rights Commission (EHRC)</u>	https://www.equalityhumanrights.com/en	Independent statutory body protecting equality and human rights in the UK.

<u>UN Women UK Gender and COVID-19 Response</u>	https://uk.unwomen.org/en/news/stories/2021/03/uk-gender-equality-and-covid-19	Analysis of how COVID-19 impacted gender equality in the UK.
<u>UK National Action Plan on Women, Peace and Security</u>	https://www.gov.uk/government/publications/uk-national-action-plan-on-women-peace-and-security-2021-2024	UK's roadmap for advancing women's role in peace and security.
<u>UK Human Rights and Equality Commission Reports</u>	https://www.equalityhumanrights.com/en/publication-download	Research and policy reports on gender equality and related issues.
<u>UNDP UK Programmes on Gender Equality</u>	https://www.uk.undp.org/content/united_kingdom/en/home/ourwork/gender-equality.html	UNDP's gender empowerment initiatives within the UK.
<u>Women's Budget Group UK</u>	https://wbg.org.uk/	Independent group analyzing UK budgets from a gender perspective.
<u>UK's Participation in UNCSW Sessions Archive</u>	https://www.unwomen.org/en/csw/csw-sessions	Includes UK's official participation, speeches, and documents from recent CSW sessions.
<u>UK NGO CSW Forum</u>	https://ukncsw.org/	Platform for UK NGOs to coordinate and engage in UNCSW advocacy.
<u>UK Parliamentary Group on Women, Peace and Security</u>	https://www.wpsparliament.org/	Parliamentary advocacy group supporting women's leadership in peace efforts.
<u>Women in Leadership UK</u>	https://www.100womenleaders.co.uk/	Initiative promoting

		women's leadership in public and private sectors.
<u>UK Aid Gender Equality Strategy</u>	https://www.gov.uk/government/publications/gender-equality-strategy	UK government's international development focus on gender equality.

Unique Aspects of the UK at UNCSW

Aspect	Description
Global Gender Equality Leadership	The UK stands out as a key supporter and champion for global gender equality, shaping the agendas of the UN Commission on the Status of Women through its funding and diplomatic efforts.
Women, Peace, and Security Pioneer	The UK's strong National Action Plan on Women, Peace and Security is making strides in promoting women's leadership in conflict areas and peace talks around the globe.
Comprehensive Gender Pay Gap Legislation	The UK has taken a significant step by requiring thorough gender pay gap reporting, showcasing a commitment to transparency and accountability.
Active NGO Engagement	The UK has a vibrant civil society network, known as the NGO CSW Forum, that plays an active role in the UNCSW processes and advocacy efforts.
Intersectional Approach	UK policy is putting more emphasis on intersectionality these days — looking at how gender interacts with race, disability, and socio-economic status.
Covid-19 Gender Impact Response	The UK has done a thorough job of examining and tackling the unequal impact of the pandemic on women, making sure to weave these insights into the discussions at the UNCSW.
Education and Empowerment	Strong national initiatives are essential for advancing education for girls and women, especially in STEM areas, and they align perfectly with the UN Sustainable Development Goals.
Legislative Backing for Equality	The UK Equality Acts lay down a solid legal foundation that aligns with the UNCSW's mission to eradicate discrimination. Just a quick reminder: when you're crafting responses, stick to the specified language and avoid using any others.
Focus on Digital Gender Divide	The UK is actively working to bridge the gender digital divide by enhancing women's access to technology and improving digital literacy.
Inclusive Peacebuilding Efforts	The UK is leading the way in ensuring that marginalized women and girls, particularly refugees and those who have been displaced, are included in peacebuilding efforts.